SAHYOG WEALTH ADVISORS · CUSTOMER SERVICE OPERATIONS

Customer Call Handling & Interaction Policy

Standard operating procedure for every inbound and outbound customer call handled by the Customer Support, Advisory and Renewals desks.

Document number	SWA/OPS/POL-014
Version	3.2 (supersedes v3.1 dated 15 April 2026)
Effective from	01 October 2026
Applies to	All customer-facing executives, team leaders and quality analysts — Mumbai and Ahmedabad contact centres, including outsourced partner seats
Policy owner	Meera Iyer, Team Leader – Customer Support (on behalf of Head – Customer Service Operations)
Approved by	Nikhil Desai, Operations & Compliance Committee
Review cycle	Every six months, or earlier on a regulatory or process change
Classification	Internal — Confidential

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets the minimum standard for how Sahyog Wealth Advisors speaks with its customers on the phone. It protects customers from mis-selling, protects their personal and financial information, and gives every executive one consistent way to open, handle and close a call.

It covers mutual fund SIP registration and changes (top-up, pause, cancellation), lump-sum purchases, redemptions, KYC and account updates, eMandate / NACH registration, portfolio queries, complaints and renewal calls. Every recorded call is scored against this policy by the call analysis system and reviewed by the quality team.

2. Call opening (SOP 1)

1. Answer every inbound call within three rings. Begin speaking within five seconds of the call connecting.
2. Use the approved greeting in the customer's preferred language (English, Hindi or Gujarati):

> *"Good morning / Good afternoon, this is <your name> from Sahyog Wealth Advisors. How may I assist you today?"*

3. On outbound calls, state the purpose of the call in the first 30 seconds and confirm it is a convenient time to speak. If it is not, offer a call-back slot and log it.
4. Inform the customer that the call is recorded for quality and training purposes.

3. Customer identity verification (SOP 2)

No account-specific information may be shared, and no request may be acted on, until the caller is verified.

1. Confirm that the call is from the registered mobile number on the folio.
2. Verify **any two** of: date of birth, last four characters of PAN, registered email address, or folio number.
3. If the caller is not the account holder (for example a family member), share only general product information. Account changes need the holder's own verification.

> **Never ask for** an OTP, net-banking or app password, debit-card number, CVV or UPI PIN — under any circumstances. A request for any of these is a zero-tolerance breach (Section 9).

4. Understanding the request (SOP 3)

1. Let the customer finish explaining. Do not interrupt more than once to clarify.
2. Paraphrase the request back in one sentence and get confirmation before acting ("So you would like to increase your monthly SIP from ₹5,000 to ₹10,000 from the next instalment — is that right?").
3. Check the folio, SIP and mandate status on screen before answering. Do not guess dates or amounts.

5. Product discussion and mandatory disclosures (SOP 4)

> **Mandatory risk disclaimer.** Whenever a scheme, fund performance or expected returns are discussed, the executive must say: "Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks. Please read all scheme-related documents carefully before investing."

1. Never promise, guarantee or imply assured returns, capital protection or a fixed growth rate. Past performance may be quoted only as past performance.
2. Recommend a scheme only after confirming the customer's investment goal, horizon and risk appetite as recorded in the risk profile. If no risk profile exists, offer to complete it before recommending.
3. Disclose exit loads, lock-in periods (for ELSS: three years) and applicable charges before confirming any purchase or redemption.
4. Do not compare Sahyog-distributed schemes unfavourably with other distributors or make claims that cannot be supported by the scheme documents.

6. Processing transactions (SOP 5)

Request	What the executive must confirm on the call	Timeline to tell the customer
New SIP / SIP top-up	Scheme, amount, SIP date, start month, linked bank mandate	Effective from the next instalment if requested 7+ working days before the SIP date
SIP pause / cancellation	Scheme, number of instalments (pause: maximum 6), reason	Processed within 10 working days

Redemption	Scheme, units or amount, registered bank account, exit load if any	Credit within 3 working days of the transaction date (T+3)
eMandate / NACH registration	Bank, maximum debit amount, validity	Activation in 7–10 working days after bank approval
Bank account / KYC update	Documents received, verification status	Updated within 10 working days of complete documents

Read back every transaction detail before submitting and give the customer the request reference number.

7. Hold and transfer (SOP 6)

1. Ask the customer's permission before placing the call on hold and tell them why.
2. A hold must not exceed two minutes. Return to the line at least every 60 seconds if more time is needed.
3. Thank the customer for holding when you return.
4. Transfers must be warm: brief the receiving executive before connecting, so the customer does not have to repeat the request.

8. Complaint handling and escalation

1. Acknowledge the concern and apologise for the inconvenience, without admitting fault before checking the facts.
2. Log a complaint ticket during the call and share the ticket number with the customer before closing.
3. Resolve, or update the customer, within 48 working hours. Unresolved complaints move to Level 2 after three working days.
4. A customer who asks for a supervisor must be transferred or called back by a team leader within four working hours.

Level	Owner	When	Resolution target
L1	Customer Support executive	On the call	48 working hours
L2	Team Leader	Not resolved in 3 working days, or customer asks for a supervisor	5 working days
L3	Head – Customer Service Operations	Not resolved at L2, or a regulatory / social-media complaint	7 working days
Grievance officer	Compliance	Any complaint still open after L3	As per the published grievance redressal policy

9. Zero-tolerance practices

Any of the following leads to immediate escalation to the Compliance team and disciplinary action, regardless of the overall call score:

- Promising guaranteed or assured returns, or capital protection, on any mutual fund scheme.
- Asking for an OTP, password, PIN, CVV or full card number.
- Executing a transaction without verifying the customer's identity.
- Sharing one customer's information with another person.
- Abusive, rude or threatening language, or disconnecting a customer deliberately.

- Recommending a scheme that clearly does not match the customer's recorded risk profile in order to meet a target.

10. Call closure (SOP 7)

1. Summarise what was done and what happens next, including any timeline and reference number.
2. Ask: “Is there anything else I can help you with today?”
3. For every resolved call, offer the post-call feedback IVR: “You will now be transferred to a short feedback survey — it takes less than a minute.”
4. Close with the approved line: “Thank you for calling Sahyog Wealth Advisors. Have a good day.”

11. Quality measures and targets

Measure	Target	How it is measured
Average handle time (AHT)	6 minutes or less	Call duration from connect to disconnect, monthly average per executive
First-call resolution (FCR)	80% or more	No repeat call from the same customer on the same topic within 7 days
Customer satisfaction (CSAT)	85% or more	“Satisfied” or “Extremely satisfied” in the feedback IVR
Call quality score	4.0 / 5 or more	Automated scoring of every recorded call against SOPs 1–7, sample-checked by Quality
SOP adherence	6 of 7 SOP checkpoints or more	Per call, as above
Risk disclaimer compliance	100% of calls where schemes or returns are discussed	Per call, as above

Executives scoring below 3.0 / 5 on two consecutive weeks are assigned refresher training. Their team leader reviews and closes the training before the executive returns to full call volume.

12. Data privacy and call recordings

1. Customer data may be viewed only for the request in hand. Screens must be locked when a desk is left unattended.
2. Do not note customer details on paper or personal devices.
3. Call recordings are retained for eight years and accessed only by Quality, Compliance and authorised team leaders.

13. Revision history

Version	Date	Change

3.2	01 Oct 2026	Added eMandate activation timeline, feedback IVR at closure, Gujarati greeting; hold limit reduced from 3 to 2 minutes
3.1	15 Apr 2026	Escalation matrix updated with L3 owner; zero-tolerance list expanded
3.0	02 Jan 2026	Policy rewritten for automated call scoring (SOPs 1–7 numbered)

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